Sparked: Australia's FHIR Accelerator

Community → clinical requirements in AUCDI → national FHIR standards in AU Core → tested and implemented → connected care.

A nationally funded, community-led accelerator creating open FHIR standards for Australia's priority use cases. Sparked is **consensus-based and bottom-up: clinical and consumer data requirements come first**, then FHIR implementation guides are built through HL7 Australia work groups, released incrementally and tested with industry.

1,500+	110+	32,500+
registered community members	founding and supporting member organisations	community expert hours

1 A partnership, powered by community

- Department of Health, Disability and Ageing
- Australian Digital Health Agency
- CSIRO Australian e-Health Research Centre
- HL7 Australia

The community: government, technology vendors (e.g. Telstra Health, Best Practice, Oracle Health, Epic, InterSystems), provider organisations, peak bodies and colleges (e.g. RACGP, AHPA, AIHW), practitioners, consumers and domain experts. Members commit to design groups and HL7 AU Connectathons. Open, inclusive and transparent: everything is published and anyone can join.

2 Five connected components

MEANING & CONTEXT
AUCDI
- R1 Jun 2024
- AUeReqDI R1 Oct 2024
- R2 Jun 2025
- R3 Jun 2026
- R4 in development

LANGUAGE & TERMS
Terminology value sets
- SNOMED CT and LOINC value sets
- With RANZCR and RCPA

SHARING & EXCHANGE
FHIR IGs
- AU Core R1, R2
- AU Patient Summary R1
- AU eRequesting R1
- AU Encounter Record (scoping)

TESTING
Test and pilot
- AU Core Inferno test kit v2
- AU PS test framework in development
- Connectathons

IMPLEMENT
Proofs of concept
- GP Chronic Condition Management Plan Smart Form
- Reference FHIR servers

3 AUCDI in more detail

What it is

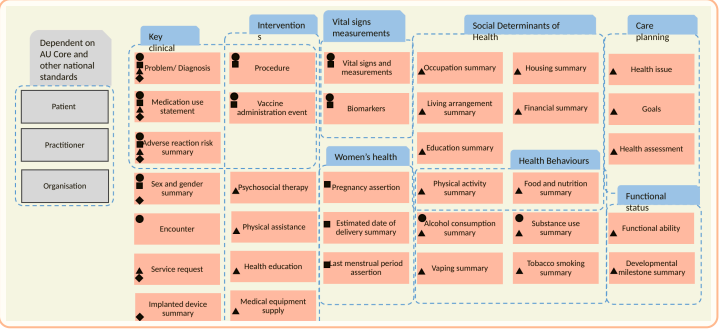
The Australian Clinical Data for Interoperability: a collection of data groups and elements for the clinical (patient care) requirements for data entry, use and sharing. Implementation-agnostic; covers the life course, health continuum and health ecosystem.

How it is built, release by release

Use cases → Prioritise → Model data → Public review → Publish

Who decides: the open **Clinical Design Group** (992 members) sets clinical priorities and requirements; **Clinical Focus Groups** of clinicians and consumers go deep on topics: Patient Summary & Encounter, and Chronic Condition Management.

AUCDI R3 scope: data groups and the use cases they support



Markers: ● core ■ patient summary ▲ chronic condition management ◆ eRequesting.
Source: Sparked overview.

4 How AUCDI feeds AU Core

CLINICAL: THE WHAT
AUCDI
Clinical Design Group defines data requirements and use cases.

→

TECHNICAL: THE HOW
AU Core
AU Core Technical Design Group and HL7 AU work groups profile it in FHIR.

→

USE CASE GUIDES
Built on AU Core
AU Patient Summary, AU Encounter Record, AU eRequesting

Derives from
AU Base (Australian identifiers, addresses, concepts)

Compatible with
IPA and IPS, so AU PS is a valid IPS

Aligned where possible
US Core, Gender Harmony

Backlogs
AUCDI and AU Core each keep a public backlog

Feedback loop: the AU Core group raises issues with draft data groups and gives regular updates; a **joint CDG–TDG harmonisation group** resolves differences. Clinicians check the technical result is clinically fit for purpose; technical teams check it can be implemented safely at scale.

5 Why it matters

More than the standards alone. Sparked has built an active, sustainable community of consumers, clinicians, industry, providers and government; grown workforce capacity in clinical information modelling and FHIR; created trust that is reused for other design and policy work; and put in place the processes and governance to deliver new use cases faster.

Sources: Sparked overview (CSIRO, 29 Sep 2026); sparked.csiro.au; HL7 Australia AU Core and AU Patient Summary IGs. AU eRequesting graduated from Sparked to HL7 Australia business-as-usual in 2026.